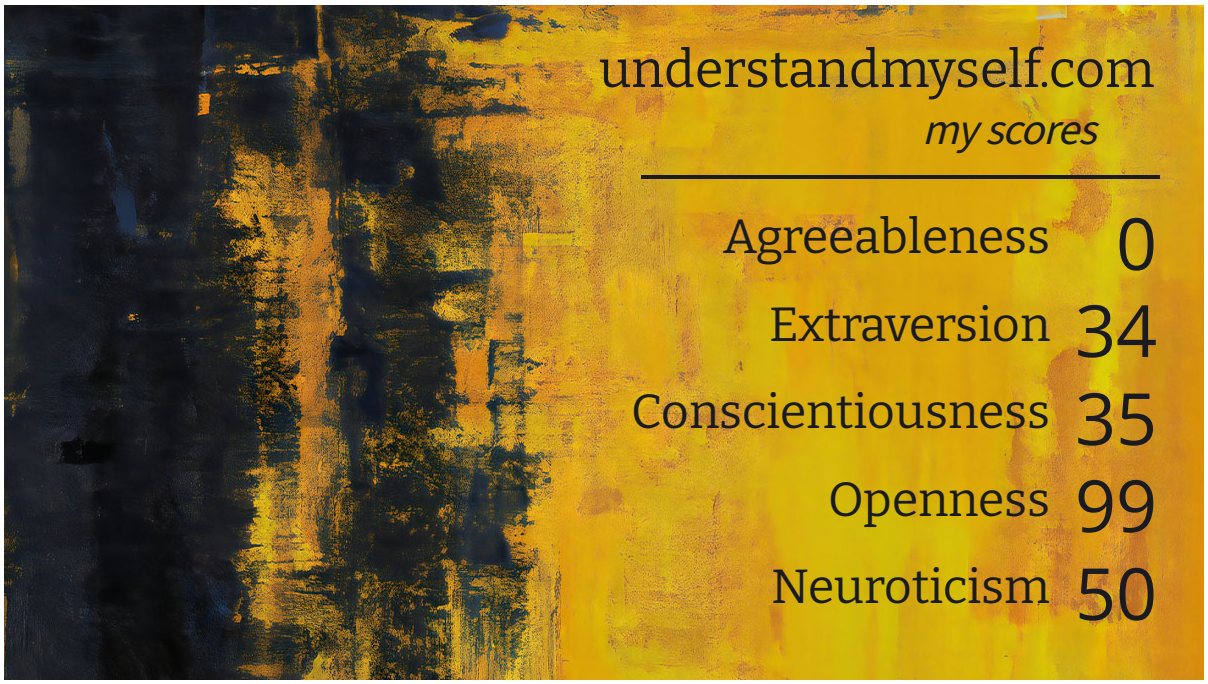
Understand Myself

Personality Assessment Report

Prepared for **Luis Gordon**

The Understand Myself personality assessment and report is based on the Big Five Aspects Scale, the scientific model that describes your personality through the (Big Five) factors and each of their two aspects. This report describes where you stand in comparison to others in the general population on the these traits and aspects.



The traits and aspects of the Big Five personality model are:

- Agreeableness: Compassion and Politeness
- Conscientiousness: Industriousness and Orderliness
- Extraversion: Enthusiasm and Assertiveness
- Neuroticism: Withdrawal and Volatility
- Openness: Intellect and Aesthetics

In the original Big Five Aspects Scale model, the openness factor was entitled "Openness to Experience," and its aspects were called "Intellect" and "Openness". For the sake of clarity, we have deviated from this, and use "Openness" or "Openness to Experience" to refer to the factor level trait and "Intellect" and "Aesthetics" to refer to its aspects.

Our systems have compared your-self-ratings to those of thousands of other people. You are being compared to men and women of all ages. This means that if you are young, your scores on neuroticism will be higher and on agreeableness and conscientiousness will be lower than if you were compared to people of your own age (with the reverse being true for older individuals). For men, their scores on agreeableness and on neuroticism will be lower than if they were just being compared to men. We decided to make the comparisons simple, so that you know where you stand in comparison to the typical person (with age and sex regarded as irrelevant).

Your scores are presented as percentiles. A percentile indicates where you stand on a particular trait with respect to the population. A percentile score of, say, 63, indicates that your score is as high or higher than 63% of the population.

Remember that each personality trait and aspect (and your relative position with respect to them) has advantages and disadvantages. It is for that reason that variation exists in the human population: there is a niche for each personality configuration. Much of what constitutes success in life is therefore the consequence of finding the place in relationships, work and personal commitment that corresponds to your unique personality structure. Good luck with your expanded self-understanding!

Note also that if you find the descriptions harsher than you might consider appropriate this may mean that you were more self-critical than necessary when completing the questions (remember, the results are based on your own self-report, compared to that of others). This can occur if you were feeling temporarily or chronically unhappy or anxious, or hungry, angry or judgmental when you completed the questions.

Agreeableness: Exceptionally Low

You are exceptionally low in agreeableness, which is the primary dimension of interpersonal interaction in the Big Five personality trait scientific model. The two aspects of agreeableness are compassion and politeness.

Your score puts you at the **0th** percentile for agreeableness. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be lower in agreeableness than **99** of them and higher in agreeableness than **0** of them.



Agreeableness is a very complex trait, with marked positive and negative elements all along its distribution. Because of this, higher scores and lower scores need to be explained at the same time. People high in agreeableness are nice: compliant, nurturing, kind, naively trusting and conciliatory. However, because of their tendency to avoid conflict, they often dissemble and hide what they think.

People low in agreeableness are not so nice: stubborn, dominant, harsh, skeptical, competitive and, in the extreme, even predatory. However, they tend to be straightforward, even blunt, so you know where they stand.

People with exceptionally low levels of agreeableness are seen by others as markedly competitive, colder, tougher and very much less empathic. They do not easily see the best in others, and are not particularly tolerant (an attitude that is much valued by agreeable people). They are very much less concerned about the emotional state of others, are uncommonly willing to engage in conflict, and will happily sacrifice peace and harmony to make a point or (if conscientious) to get things done. People may find them painfully straightforward and blunt. They tend very strongly towards dominance, rather than submission (particularly if also below average in neuroticism).

People with exceptionally low levels of agreeableness do not at all easily forgive. They are definitely not accepting, flexible, gentle or patient. They feel minimal pity for those who are excluded, punished or defeated, and attribute such problems to weakness or inability. They are also extremely unlikely to be taken advantage of by disagreeable, manipulative or otherwise troublesome people, or those with criminal or predatory intent. Their extraordinarily high levels of skepticism play a protective role, although it often interferes with their ability to cooperate with or trust others whose intentions are genuinely good. They are also much less likely to reward good behavior or to give credit where it is due. They cooperate grudgingly, and only when cooperation is in their clear self-interest, preferring competition, with its well-defined losers and winners. They do not lose arguments (or avoid discussions) with anyone, for any reason, and enjoy the battle. This can interfere with their ability to learn from experience (their own or others'). They are very likely to be expert at bargaining for themselves, and at negotiating for more recognition or power, and are likely to have higher salaries and to earn more money, in consequence. People exceptionally low in agreeableness are therefore less likely to suffer from resentment or to harbour invisible anger.

They let you know exactly what they think, when they think it, whether you want to know it or not. In addition, because of their tendency to engage in conflict, at a moment's notice, people exceptionally low in agreeableness do not sacrifice medium- to long-term stability and functionality for the sake of short-term peace. This means that problems that should be solved in the present are often solved, quickly and harshly. This means that such problems may not accumulate counterproductively across time. The price paid for this? People close to those exceptionally low in agreeableness will frequently experience them as overbearing and uncaring.

Women are higher in agreeableness than men. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 61.5. For men it is 38.5. The fact that men are lower in agreeableness than women helps explain their much higher rates of criminal incarceration (90% male). The primary difference between criminals and non-criminals is disagreeableness. If the typical criminal is more disagreeable than 98% of people in the general population, then almost all those criminals will be male. This difference in agreeableness between men and women is largest in countries such as Norway and Sweden, where the most has been done to ensure equality of outcome between the sexes. This provides strong evidence that biological factors rather than environment and learning account for the dissimilarity.

Agreeableness, per se, is not strongly associated with political liberalism or conservatism, but this is because the aspects of agreeableness predict such political belief in opposite ways, and cancel each other out. Liberals are higher in aspect compassion, and conservatives in aspect politeness. However, alliance with the category of belief that has come to be known as politically correct is strongly predicted by agreeableness (particularly compassion). What this appears to mean is that agreeable people strongly identify with those they deem oppressed, seeing them, essentially, as exploited infants, and demonize those they see as oppressors, seeing them as cruel, heartless predators.

There are large differences between men and women in terms of spontaneous interest, and these also appear associated with agreeableness. Agreeable people, caring as they do for others, are more likely to enter professions associated with people, such as teaching and nursing, which are dominated by women. This is true even in the Scandinavian countries, where attempts to produce gender-equal societies has reached a maximum.

Disagreeable people, by contrast, appear to prefer systematizing over empathizing, and are more interested in things – machines and technology. In consequence, professions such as engineering and trades associated with construction and machinery tend to be dominated by relatively disagreeable men.

Compassion: Exceptionally Low

You are exceptionally low in compassion. Compassion is an aspect of agreeableness. The other aspect of agreeableness is politeness.

Your score puts you at the **0th** percentile for compassion. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be lower in compassion than **99** of them and higher in compassion than **0** of them.



Exceptionally less compassionate people are not at all oriented towards the problems of other people or other living things. They are not swayed or emotionally engaged by helplessness or cuteness. They are very willing, even happy, to make other people experience negative emotion by engaging in conflict and competition.

They want to win, period, and will engage in the confrontation necessary to do so. They are therefore very much less concerned about helping other people. They make certain their own needs and interests are attended to, and are extraordinarily unwilling to sacrifice for the sake of other people's comfort. This can make them harsh and unsympathetic. People might turn to them for the blunt, cold, hard truth, but never for a soft, patient, eternally-listening ear. They are remarkably less empathetic and caring. However, because they are not primarily other-oriented, they can negotiate expertly on their own behalf, and get at least what they deserve (and perhaps more). In consequence, they are unlikely to harbor feelings of resentment or hidden anger. They find it difficult to trust, however, even when such trust would be productive, and other people are likely to find them callous and unfeeling.

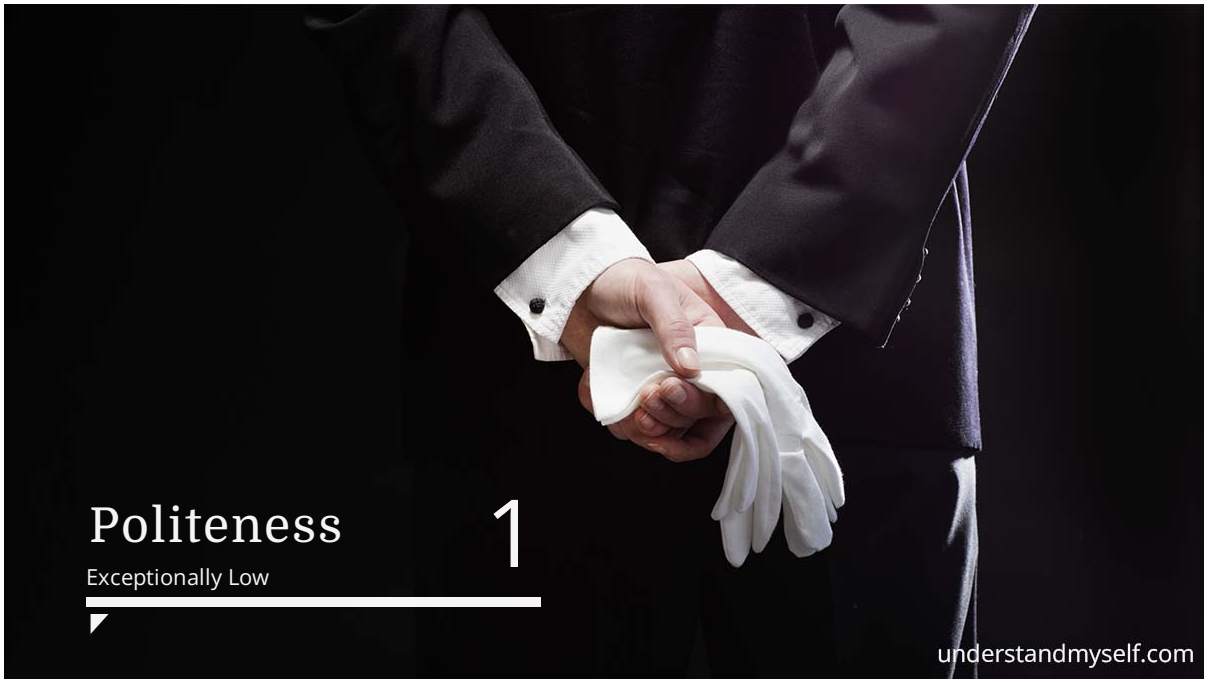
Those who are liberal, politically, score somewhat higher in compassion than conservatives.

Women are also higher in compassion than men. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 61. For men it is 39.

Politeness: Exceptionally Low

You are exceptionally low in politeness. Politeness is an aspect of agreeableness. The other aspect of agreeableness is compassion.

Your score puts you at the **1st** percentile for politeness. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be lower in politeness than **98** of them and higher in politeness than **1** of them.



People who are exceptionally low in politeness challenge and confront authority – and they are not obedient. If they are respectful, it is grudgingly, and will only be manifested toward people who continually both deserve and demand it. They are comfortable confronting other people, and enjoy it.

People extremely low in politeness are motivated to engage in conflict, and to seek out confrontation. They may have a strong tendency toward conduct-disordered, antisocial, delinquent, even criminal behavior, particularly if male and adolescent. They may find themselves very frequently in trouble with authority, in consequence. Their skepticism can make it extremely difficult for them to find a place in the middle or lower in hierarchies of power and dominance. They are hyper-dominant, rather than submissive (particularly if they are also low in neuroticism).

Those who are liberal, politically, score somewhat lower in politeness than conservatives (the opposite pattern is seen with compassion).

Women are higher in politeness than men. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 59. For men it is 41.

Conscientiousness: Moderately Low

You are moderately low in conscientiousness, which is the primary dimension of dutiful achievement in the Big Five personality trait scientific model.

Your score puts you at the **35th** percentile for conscientiousness. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be lower in conscientiousness than **64** of them and higher in conscientiousness than **35** of them.



Conscientiousness is a measure of obligation, attention to detail, hard work, persistence, cleanliness, efficiency and adherence to rules, standards and processes. Conscientious people implement their plans and establish and maintain order. The two aspects of conscientiousness are industriousness and orderliness.

People moderately low in conscientiousness are not particularly dutiful. They are by no means sloggers. They will only work hard if pushed, and don't mind wasting time. They are quite likely to procrastinate (particularly if they are also above average in neuroticism). If people with moderately low levels of conscientiousness commit to doing something, there is a good chance they will be late, or delayed, even if there isn't much reason for it. They tend to find and deliver excuses for their failure under such circumstances. They are not markedly decisive, neat, organized, future-oriented, or reliable, and they find themselves easily distracted.

People with moderately low levels of conscientiousness are less likely to obtain higher grades in academic settings (particularly if they are also less intelligent), and generally require substantial supervision to stay on task. For this reason, they make less than optimal managers and administrators. They do not feel compelled to do things by the book, however. This can perhaps be an advantage if they are engaged in creative tasks, where rules must be broken for advancement to take place. They are unlikely to make career accomplishment a primary goal, turning instead to pursuit of safety and security (if high in neuroticism), creative accomplishment (if high in openness), establishment of intimate relationships and friendships (if highly agreeable), or social success, excitement and fun (if extraverted).

People moderately low in conscientiousness tend to be relatively free of guilt, shame, self-disgust and self-contempt. Other people, however, may react negatively to their tendency to slack off (particularly if those other people are disagreeable and conscientious).

Individuals who are moderately low in conscientiousness are not particularly concerned by failure. They are not judgmental, to themselves or others, and tend towards situational explanations for disappointment, frustration or lack of success. They can handle periods of inactivity and unemployment with relative ease. They tend to downplay the relationship between hard work, diligence and success, believing that chance factors and luck in life play a determining role. They live, in large part, for leisure and very much look forward to time off. They can be good at relaxing, and living in the moment (particularly when low in neuroticism). They are less concerned than average with cleaning, moral purity and achievement. It's more fun to be at the beach or at a party with a person moderately low in conscientiousness – but you might not want to invite them over on moving day.

People moderately low in conscientiousness are more likely to be political liberals rather than conservatives. This is particularly true if they are also high in openness.

Women are very slightly more conscientious than men. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 51.5. For men it is 49.5.

Industriousness: Moderately Low

You are moderately low in industriousness. Industriousness is an aspect of conscientiousness. The other aspect of conscientiousness is orderliness.

Your score puts you at the **27th** percentile for industriousness. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be lower in industriousness than **72** of them and higher in industriousness than **27** of them.



People who are lower in industriousness are less likely to be successful in school and in administrative and managerial positions (particularly if they are also less intelligent). If they are highly intelligent, they are likely to be regarded as underachievers.

They don't focus on work as much as others and are more likely to procrastinate, miss deadlines, or fail to complete assignments or projects completely. They have a tendency to put off responsibilities, concentrating more on fun, worry, relationships, excitement or creative endeavour. They aren't particularly concerned with schedules, timelines or efficiency, and may have to be supervised excessively before their tasks will be completed. They lack focus and are easily distracted.

People moderately low in industriousness are not judgmental to themselves or others. They tend to let people, including themselves, off the hook. They are less likely to believe that people fail because they don't apply themselves or work hard, assuming that chance and luck play the determining roles. They are not prone to guilt, self-disgust or self-contempt, and have a laissez-faire, whatever-will-be-will-be attitude toward life.

Those who are liberal and those who are conservative appear equally industrious.

Men are slightly more industrious than women. The mean percentile for men in a general population (women and men) is 51.5. For women it is 49.5.

Orderliness: Typical or Average

You are typical or average in orderliness. Orderliness is an aspect of conscientiousness. The other aspect of conscientiousness is industriousness.

Your score puts you at the **48th** percentile for orderliness. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be higher in orderliness than **48** of them and lower in orderliness than **51** of them.



Typically orderly people are neither particularly disturbed nor disgusted by mess and chaos. They keep everything moderately tidy and organized. They don't think in terms of simple black and white; in their world, there are many shades of grey. They don't rely overmuch on schedules, lists or routines, preferring to take things as they come.

They are not overly oriented toward detail, rigidly rule-abiding or judgmental.

They like routine and predictability, under some circumstances, but don't mind if such things are disrupted. They can manage complex, sensitive processes when supervised properly and carefully, but may have to be reminded to pay proper attention and maintain focus. They can, however, tolerate the mess, disruption and intervening periods of chaos that may accompany creative endeavor.

Those who are average in orderliness are no more likely to be political conservatives or liberals, although they will tend toward the former if low in openness and the latter if high.

Women are more orderly than men. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 54.5. For men it is 45.5. This may account for some of the trouble in relation to housework between women and men. Since women are, on average, more orderly, household disorder will trigger disgust and discomfort in them faster. This may happen with sufficient frequency so they end up doing a disproportionate share of such work (even though if they waited a bit longer their less orderly partners, often men, might end up equally troubled and motivated to fix the problem). Orderly people are more likely to have items such as event calendars, drawer organizers, laundry baskets, irons and ironing boards in their immediate environments.

Extraversion: Moderately Low

You are moderately low in extraversion, which is the primary dimension of positive emotion in the Big Five personality trait scientific model. Extraversion is a measure of general sensitivity to positive emotions such as hope, joy, anticipation and approach, particularly in social situations. The two aspects of extraversion are enthusiasm and assertiveness.

Your score puts you at the **34th** percentile for extraversion. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be lower in extraversion than **65** of them and higher in extraversion than **34** of them.



Since extraversion and introversion are poles that denote the ends of the spectrum for this trait, you can also think of yourself as moderately introverted.

People with moderately low levels of extraversion are not particularly enthusiastic, talkative, assertive in social situations, or gregarious. They tend to find excessive social contact draining and tiring, and crave time alone to recharge. They are less likely to plan parties, tell jokes, make people laugh, or volunteer for community activities. They are somewhat more likely to be depressed and to have lower levels of self-esteem (particularly if they are high in neuroticism). They are less optimistic about the past, present and future.

People who are moderately low in extraversion find it relatively easy to keep things to themselves. They are not compelled to share everything with everyone. They are not particularly self-disclosing and do not warm up quickly to other people. They are more comfortable with one-to-one interactions than in a group-oriented situation. They are rarely the first to speak in meetings, although they will express an opinion if asked. They are less likely to captivate and convince, and will rarely be the first to act in an ambiguous situation.

People who are moderately low in extraversion are better suited to occupations that require working alone or with a few other well-known individuals (such as computer programming or accounting). Jobs involving sales, persuasion, working in groups and public speaking are unlikely to appeal to them, and they are less likely to be successful at such things (particularly if they are also high in neuroticism).

People moderately low in extraversion are relatively unlikely to be impulsive, even when offered the opportunity to do something exciting or fun. They are therefore less likely to sacrifice the future to the present, when something social or group-oriented beckons. They find it relatively easy to be alone to study and work. They are not easily distracted by opportunities to chat, joke and socialize. This is particularly the case if they are also high in conscientiousness. However, when people are introverted and conscientious, they are less productive than when extraverted and conscientious, perhaps because they have lower levels of energy. When introverted and comparatively unconscientious, however, they are more productive than when extraverted and unconscientious.

People moderately low in extraversion tend to be less dominant in social situations, particularly if they are also low in agreeableness. Less agreeable extraverts tend to be self-centered – something that can be made worse if they are also low in conscientiousness. More introverted people are somewhat protected against such tendencies.

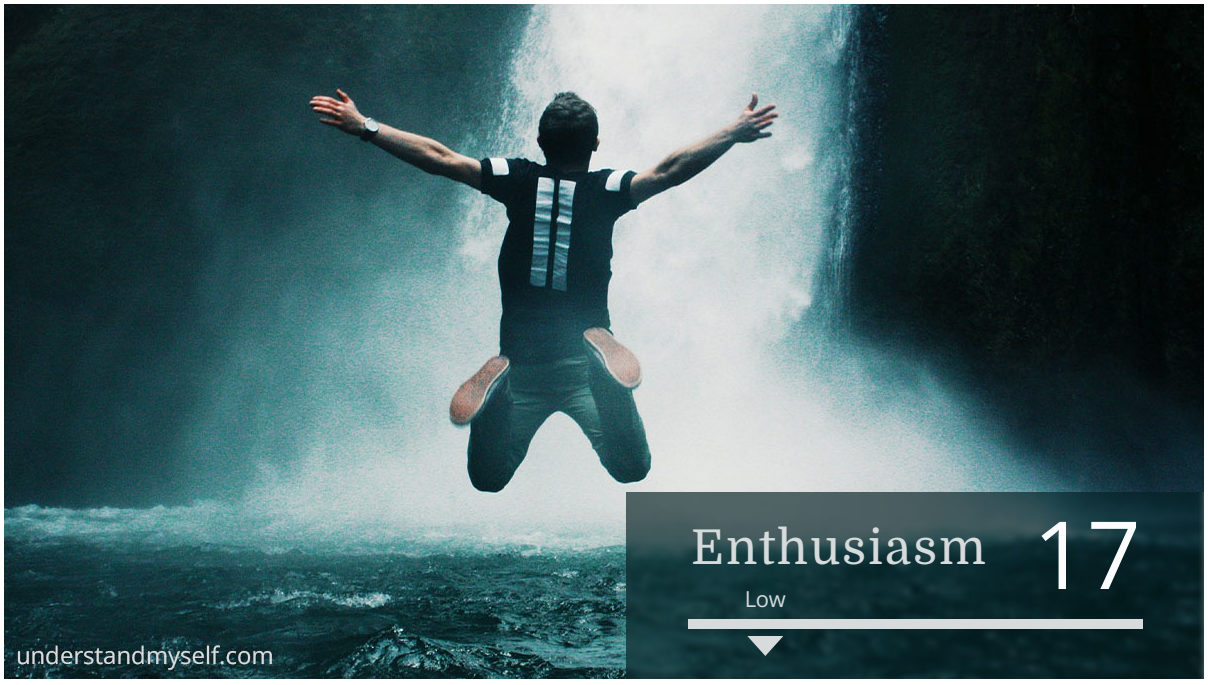
Those who are politically liberal are slightly less extraverted than conservatives.

Women are slightly more extraverted than men. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 52. For men it is 48.

Enthusiasm: Low

You are low in enthusiasm. Enthusiasm is an aspect of extraversion. The other aspect of extraversion is assertiveness.

Your score puts you at the **17th** percentile for enthusiasm. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be lower in enthusiasm than **82** of them and higher in enthusiasm than **17** of them.



Individuals who are low in enthusiasm are not excitable. They are also much less easy to get to know, as they are not chatty or bubbly. When they do talk, it tends to be about things in which they find particular interest.

They open up to other people with some difficulty, particularly in larger social gatherings or parties. They laugh much more rarely than others. They prefer solitude and, although they can enjoy themselves around other people, it has to be in small doses. They are much more private people, and are not markedly positive or optimistic. They avoid the spotlight and, if creative, may find performing much less desirable and draining. They rarely seek out stimulation, excitement, activity or fun (and, if they do so, prefer quieter activities). People low in enthusiasm are not gregarious or people-loving, and find it more difficult to generate a felt sense of excitement when offered the opportunity to engage in something that others might find engaging or entertaining.

Enthusiasm is not strongly associated with political preference, either conservative or liberal.

Women are higher in enthusiasm than men. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 55. For men it is 45.

Assertiveness: Typical or Average

You are typical or average in assertiveness. Assertiveness is an aspect of extraversion. The other aspect of extraversion is enthusiasm.

Your score puts you at the **58th** percentile for assertiveness. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be higher in assertiveness than **58** of them and lower in assertiveness than **41** of them.



People of average assertiveness will sometimes take charge, spontaneously, but often let others step in first. They can put forward their own opinions but do not feel compelled to do so. They are not particularly dominant and do not generally strive to control social situations.

At times, they can act in an influential or captivating manner, but it is not habitual. They can act, in ambiguous situations, but will often let others lead the way. They tend not to be particularly impulsive, and tend not to act without thinking.

Liberals tend to be slightly less assertive than conservatives.

Women are slightly less assertive than men. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 48. For men it is 52.

Neuroticism: Typical or Average

You are typical or average in neuroticism, which is the primary dimension of negative emotion in the Big Five personality trait scientific model. Neuroticism is a measure of general sensitivity to negative emotions such as pain, sadness, irritable or defensive anger, fear and anxiety. The two aspects of neuroticism are withdrawal and volatility.

Your score puts you at the **50th** percentile for neuroticism. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be higher in neuroticism than **50** of them and lower in neuroticism than **49** of them.



People with typical or average levels of neuroticism have a balanced view of the happiness and sadness of the past, present and future.

Sometimes they are unhappy, anxious and irritable, particularly when facing a genuine problem, but they generally cope well and don't worry too much.

They have normal levels of self-esteem, particularly when they are also average or above average in extraversion. They are not particularly at risk for developing anxiety disorders and depression.

People with average or typical levels of neuroticism are able to experience the consequences of success and to be appropriately satisfied in relationships and career. Average levels of neuroticism are associated with no more than average concern about mental and physical health, a typical number of physician and emergency room visits, and an expected degree of absenteeism at work and at school (unless accompanied by very low levels of conscientiousness).

People with average levels of neuroticism appear to neither seek risk out, nor avoid it. They are interested in security, but can also handle recreational, career, financial and social situations where the possibility of loss is higher. Such people appear to be concerned both with maintaining their current status, as well as enhancing it. This is a reasonable strategy in genuinely dangerous or uncertain times and better times alike.

Neuroticism is not a powerful predictor of political belief, either conservative or liberal.

Females tend to be higher in neuroticism than males. The typical woman is higher in neuroticism than 60% of the general population of men and women combined. In part, this may be why women report more unhappiness in their relationships, at work, in school and with their health than men, on average, and why women initiate 70% of all divorces. This difference in neuroticism between men and women appears to emerge at puberty. It is largest in countries such as Norway and Sweden, where the most has been done to ensure equality of outcome between the sexes. This provides strong evidence that biological factors rather than environment and learning account for the dissimilarity.

Withdrawal: Typical or Average

You are typical or average in withdrawal. Withdrawal is an aspect of neuroticism. The other aspect of neuroticism is volatility.

Your score puts you at the **52nd** percentile for withdrawal. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be higher in withdrawal than **52** of them and lower in withdrawal than **47** of them.



Individuals average in withdrawal may occasionally suffer from anticipatory anxiety, but are generally not impeded by it. They can handle new, uncertain, unexpected, threatening or complex situations quite well. They are not more likely to avoid or withdraw in the face of the unknown and unexpected.

People with average levels of withdrawal sometimes feel sad, lonesome, disappointed and grief-stricken, but not too deeply, and not for too long. They experience normal levels of doubt and worry, embarrassment, self-consciousness and discouragement in the face of threat and punishment. They are reasonably but not excessively sensitive to social rejection, and don't feel hurt too easily. Even when hurt, frightened, or anxious, they can recover in a reasonable amount of time. People with typical levels of withdrawal are not particularly concerned that something bad is going to happen. Technically, withdrawal has been associated with activity in the brain systems that regulate passive avoidance.

Those who are liberal, politically, are slightly higher in withdrawal than conservatives.

Women are higher in withdrawal than men. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 60. For men it is 40.

Volatility: Typical or Average

You are typical or average in volatility. Volatility is an aspect of neuroticism. The other aspect of neuroticism is withdrawal.

Your score puts you at the **48th** percentile for volatility. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be higher in volatility than **48** of them and lower in volatility than **51** of them.



Individuals average in volatility tend not to vary abnormally in their mood. They are not particularly irritable, and feel no more than typical levels of disappointment, frustration, pain and social isolation.

They express their frustration, disappointment and irritability reasonably and not excessively often. Even when stirred up and upset or angry or irritated, they calm down relatively quickly. They are no more argumentative than average and infrequently lose their composure.

If provoked in a dispute, a person of average volatility may react in kind (particularly if also low in agreeableness). However, such people generally remain calm and unperturbed, even when stressed.

Volatile people tend to get upset if something bad does happen, while people high in withdrawal (the other aspect of neuroticism) tend to be concerned that something bad might happen. Technically, volatility has been associated with activity in the brain systems that regulate fight, flight or freeze.

Volatility is not strongly related to political preference, either liberal or conservative.

Women are higher in volatility than men. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 57.5. For men it is 42.5.

Openness: Exceptionally High

You are exceptionally high in openness, which is the primary dimension of creativity, artistic interest and intelligence (particularly verbal intelligence) in the Big Five personality trait scientific model. Openness is a measure of interest in novelty, art, literature, abstract thinking, philosophy as well as sensitivity to aesthetic emotions and beauty. The two aspects of openness are intellect and aesthetics.

Your score puts you at the **99th** percentile for openness. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be higher in openness than **99** of them and lower in openness than **0** of them.



People with exceptionally high levels of openness are almost always characterized by others as extremely smart, creative, exploratory, intelligent and visionary.

They are extremely interested in learning, and are constantly acquiring new abilities and skills. They are extremely curious and exploratory. They are exceptionally interested in abstract thinking, philosophy, and the meaning of belief systems and ideologies. They live for cultural events such as movies, concerts, dance recitals, plays, poetry readings, gallery openings and art shows. They are very likely to enjoy writing (or even to be driven to write). They enjoy complex, abstract ideas and deeply love to confront and solve complex, abstract and multi-dimensional problems.

They are almost always prolific readers, and are interested in a vast range of topics. They have an exceptionally broad and deep vocabulary. They can think and learn remarkably quickly. They are unusually proficient at formulating new ideas, and can be exceptionally articulate (particularly if average or above in extraversion). People exceptionally high in openness can see old things in remarkable ways. They can think outside of the box. When they hear or come up with an idea, many other ideas are usually triggered. They can formulate any single problem in an exceptionally diverse range of ways, and can generate a tremendously large number of problem-solving solutions. They will constantly seek change, often to make things better, but also just for the sake of change.

People who are exceptionally high in openness are poorly adapted to and do not do well in situations or occupations that are routinized and predictable. They fit badly at the bottom of hierarchies. They are unusually ill-suited to entry-level, repetitive, rote positions, because they are always thinking up new ways to do things, and such ideas are seldom welcome from someone at the bottom. They are extremely radical thinkers. They shake things up, particularly if they are also disagreeable and assertive. They are likely to be revolutionary rebels (particularly if average or below in conscientiousness).

Individuals exceptionally high in openness are entrepreneurial in spirit, as well as smart and creative. They can be overwhelmingly interested in creating new ventures, sometimes for profit, sometimes for curiosity, and sometimes for personal transformation. Exceptionally high levels of openness appear necessary to the formation and leadership of business and other forms of complex organization, although conscientiousness appears required for the attention to detail and process management that such organizations also always need.

Because people who are exceptionally high in openness are interested in absolutely everything, they can find it hard to settle on a single path in life, to specialize to a necessary degree, and to create an integrated identity. This is particularly dangerous if they are above average in neuroticism and/or below average in conscientiousness. People characterized by the combination of high openness and high neuroticism constantly undermine their own convictions and beliefs by incessant questioning and make themselves lost and anxious. Open, unconscientious people tend to be “under-achievers” (particularly if also above average in neuroticism). Such people appear to have the capability to succeed, can learn quickly, and are creative, but they seldom implement their ideas.

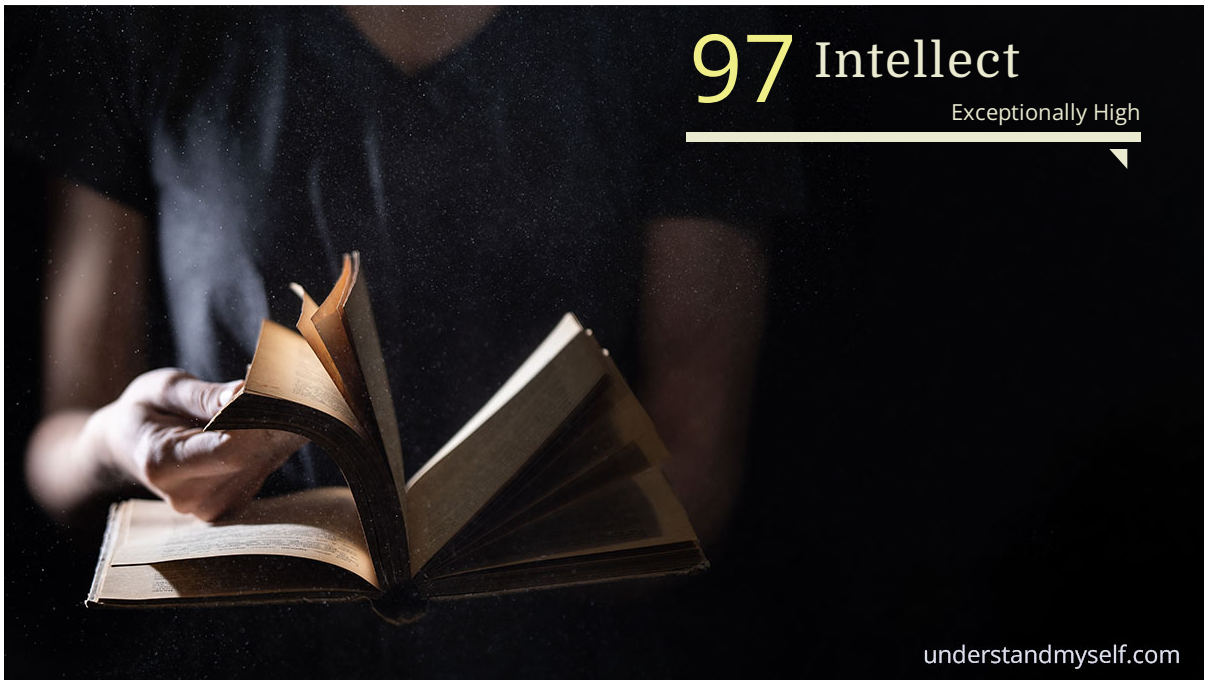
Openness is the dimension that best predicts political allegiance (with conscientiousness, particularly the aspect of orderliness, coming in at second place). Those who are liberal, politically, are very much more likely to be high in openness than conservatives.

Women and men differ very little in openness at the trait level, although there are differences in the aspect levels.

Intellect: Exceptionally High

You are exceptionally high in intellect. Intellect is an aspect of openness. The other aspect of openness is aesthetics.

Your score puts you at the **97th** percentile for intellect. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be higher in intellect than **97** of them and lower in intellect than **2** of them.



Note: Do not confuse the personality aspect of Intellect with IQ. Intellect is a measure of interest in abstract ideas, essentially, while IQ is a measure of processing speed, verbal ability, working memory, and problem solving capacity, and is better measured with a formal IQ test. It is perfectly possible to have a high IQ and a low score on the personality trait of Intellect.

People exceptionally high in intellect are obsessed by engaging with ideas and abstract concepts. They require exposure to novel information, particularly when it is complex and sophisticated. They are extremely curious and exploratory, and actively need to find, tackle and solve challenging problems. They will constantly seek out and initiate issue-oriented discussions, and tend to compulsively read, think about and discuss idea-centered books (generally non-fiction). They are notably articulate, and can formulate ideas very clearly and exceptionally quickly (particularly if average or higher in extraversion). They have a much broader and wider vocabulary, and continually require themselves to learn new things. People exceptionally high in intellect will continually find and generate novel, creative concepts and voluntarily search for and adapt exceptionally well to new experiences and situations.

People exceptionally high in intellect find complex, rapidly changing occupations absolutely necessary and will excel at them (particularly if they are also high in conscientiousness and low in neuroticism). However, they are not at all suited to stable, straightforward and more traditional occupations, where the rules don't change, and will experience continual periods of boredom and intolerable levels of frustration in such positions. They are much more suited to entrepreneurial/creative enterprises (particularly if also high in the aesthetics aspect of openness).

Liberals are higher in intellect than conservatives (although the biggest difference between the two is openness at the trait level).

Women are lower than men in intellect (although not in IQ). This is probably a difference in interest: people high in intellect, compared to aesthetics, are more likely to prefer the sciences to the arts. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 45. For men it is 55.

Aesthetics: Exceptionally High

You are exceptionally high in aesthetics. Aesthetics is an aspect of openness. The other aspect of openness is intellect.

Your score puts you at the **97th** percentile for aesthetics. If you were one of 100 people in a room, you would be higher in aesthetics than **97** of them and lower in aesthetics than **2** of them.



In the original Big Five Aspects Scale model, the openness factor was entitled "Openness to Experience," and its aspects were called "Intellect" and "Openness". For the sake of clarity, we have deviated from this, and use "Openness" or "Openness to Experience" to refer to the factor level trait and "Intellect" and "Aesthetics" to refer to its aspects.

Generally speaking, a person's aesthetics score reflects their creativity. People who are exceptionally high in aesthetics love beauty. They must have an outlet for their creative ability, or they simply cannot thrive. They must be surrounded by art or beautiful crafts. They are extremely sensitive to color and architectural form. They love to collect things, sometimes to the point of obsession. They are exceptionally imaginative, and love to daydream and reflect on things. They are remarkably affected by music, of many genres, and are likely to be musical or artistic themselves (both of these are rare in the general population). They can get completely immersed in a book, or a movie, or in their own thoughts, and become totally oblivious to the outside world. They respond unusually strongly to beauty, creativity and art.

They can be impractical and flighty, however (particularly if low in conscientiousness). It can be extremely difficult to transform creativity into money, or into a career. High levels of creativity are, however, necessary for entrepreneurial success, and often prove useful at the top of hierarchies, even in very conservative occupations such as banking, accounting and law, which need creative people in leadership positions to provide new vision and direction.

Liberals are higher in aesthetics than conservatives (although the biggest difference between the two is openness at the trait level).

Women are higher in aesthetics than men. The mean percentile for women in a general population (women and men) is 56.5. For men it is 44.5.